INCH-POUND

A-A-20165A
February 14, 1994
SUPERSEDING
A-A-20165
January 29, 1988

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

POTATO-BASED MIXES, GRANULAR, DEHYDRATED (FOR FRENCH-FRIED TYPE PRODUCTS)

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description in preference to Military Specification MIL-P-43744.

This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers dehydrated granular potato-based mixes, for use with extruder equipment with an internal rehydrating device, packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by the Federal Government.

Salient characteristics.

The dehydrated granular potato-based mixes shall conform to the following types when specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order:

Types.

Type I - French-fried potato mix
Type II - French-fried onion ring mix

The dehydrated potato granules shall be prepared from clean, sound, white fleshed whole or potato pieces which are dehydrated in accordance with good manufacturing practices The

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Commander, U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, ATTN: SATNC-WTP, Natick, MA 01760-5018.

FSC 8915

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

dehydrated onion pieces shall comply with the Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products.

Type I - French-fried potato mix. The mix shall be composed of dehydrated potato granules, starch, guar gum, salt, hydroxypropyl methycellulose, natural and artificial flavors, Vitamin C (ascorbic acid), sodium bisulfite, butylated hydroxyanisole, and/or butylated hydroxytoluene

Type II - French-fried onion mix. The mix shall be composed of dehydrated potato granules, dehydrated onion pieces, starch, guar gum, salt, natural and artificial flavors, hydroxypropyl methycellulose, Vitamin C (ascorbic acid), sodium bisulfite, butylated hydroxyanisole, and/or butylated hydroxytoluene

All ingredients shall be of Food Chemicals Codex purity Each mix shall contain not more than 7 0 percent moisture, shall have a sulfite content of 200-500 ppm [calculated as sulphur dioxide in parts per million (ppm)], and shall contain not less than 22 mg/oz. of Vitamin C The mixes shall be granular, in a pelletized form, and shall be free of lumps that will not break under slight finger pressure The mixes shall be free from extraneous matter.

Directions on the package shall include the following

FOR USE IN POTATO EXTRUDER EQUIPMENT WITH INTERNAL REHYDRATING DEVICE. OPEN CAN/BAG, POUR INTO HOPPER.

When prepared in accordance with label directions the following shall apply

Type I product shall meet color standards not lighter than USDA No 0 nor darker than USDA No 2 color standard for frozen french-fried potatoes and shall be practically free from variable colors The texture shall be typical of Grade A french-fried potatoes. The fat content shall be not less than 15 0 percent and shall not exceed 22 0 percent by weight of the finished product The Type I product shall have a typical french-fried potato flavor and shall be free from objectionable odors and flavors.

Type II product shall be equivalent to color standards not lighter than USDA No 0 nor darker then USDA No. 4 color standard for frozen french-fried potatoes and shall be practically free from variable colors The texture shall be typical of high quality frozen onion rings. The fat content shall be not less than 15 0 percent and shall not exceed 22 0 percent by weight of the finished product The Type II product shall have a typical french-fried onion ring flavor and shall be free from objectionable odors and flavors

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Analytical requirements.

Chemical analyses shall be made in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC or the Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists (AACC) as follows:

Test	Method
Moisture 1/ (loss on drying)	AOAC 925.45A
Sulfite	AOAC 962 16
Fat	AACC 30-25
Vitamin C	AACC 86-10

1/ Place the sample dishes with cocked lids in the vacuum-oven and dry for 6 hours at 70°C under a pressure of not more than 100 mm of mercury.

Other Standards

Color. Colors shall be determined by using USDA color standards for frozen french-fried potatoes.

Testing in dispenser equipment with internal rehydrating device.

Follow Series 500 dispenser machine operating, cleaning, and charging instructions Open a can or bag of potato mix product, pour the contents into the dispenser machine hopper When the potato mix is fully rehydrated, the ready light on the front of dispenser will illuminate Depress the ready button, the dispenser machine will automatically dispense a 22 ounce (624 g) portion for sampling. Collect the formed product on a transfer tray. The dispensed potato mix product pieces or shapes should be uniformly formed. Dispensed product should not be soupy or contain dry pockets of unrehydrated potato mix.

Dispense another 22 ounce (624 g) portion for sampling onto a transfer tray Submerge the fry basket into good quality clean vegetable oil heated to 350°F. Place the dispensed product into the submerged fry basket Wait 10 seconds, raise the fry basket and lightly shake the product, resubmerge the basket and continue cooking for 80 seconds or to desired color.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Contractor's certification.

By submitting an offer, the contractor certifies that the product offered meets the specified salient characteristics and requirements of this CID, conforms to the producer's own specifications and standards, including product characteristics, manufacturing procedures, quality control procedures, and storage and handling practices, has a national or regional distribution from storage facilities located within the United States, its territories, or possessions; and is sold on the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to determine proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery from point of origin and at any time thereafter, up to and including delivery at final destination, as may be necessary to determine conformance with the provisions of the contract

Regulatory requirements.

Delivered product shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sales of the product within the commercial marketplace Delivered product shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

Quality assurance.

When the solicitation, contract, or purchase order requires that product quality or acceptability or both be determined by the Processed Products Branch (PPB), Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U S. Department of Agriculture, shall be the certifying activity and shall make the determination in accordance with applicable PPB procedures The product shall be examined or analyzed or both in accordance with applicable provisions in the CID, and when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers.

Sample for testing.

The sample for analytical testing shall be a one-pound (454 g) composite sample derived from the samples drawn for quality. Results for fat and moisture shall be reported to the nearest 0 1 percent Results for sulfite content shall be reported to the nearest 10 ppm Results for Vitamin C shall be reported to the nearest 1 mg/oz

Preparation of sample for analytical testing.

Prepare a clean, dry Waring Blendor or similar mill by grinding a sample and then discarding it Grind approximately 100 grams of the well-mixed sample in the prepared Waring Blendor or similar mill for one minute Place the ground material in a small, dry,

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T08:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

tightly-closed container for at least 1/2 hour. Pass the ground material over a U.S Standard No 20 sieve nested on a U S Standard No. 40 sieve That portion which passes through the 20 mesh screen but not the 40 mesh screen is to be analyzed and shall be weighed immediately or placed in a small, dry container with a tightly closed lid until ready for analysis (a one-half pint Mason jar is satisfactory).

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking.

The dehydrated granular potato-based mixes shall be preserved, packaged, packed, labeled, and cases marked in accordance with good commercial practice. Commercial labeling and packaging, as may be augmented by the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, shall be acceptable Shipping containers shall comply with the National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable.

For Department of Defense procurements.

The following requirements are applicable when specified by the contracting officer

A. Commercial packaging. Two and one-half pounds (1.134 kg) of product shall be packaged in a can or four and one-half pounds (2.041 kg) of product shall be packaged in a polylaminated or kraft bag in accordance with commercial practice

B. Commercial packing. Six cans or six bags, as applicable, shall be packed in fiberboard boxes complying with Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable.

C. Export packaging. Two and one-half pounds (1 134 kg) of product shall be packaged in a 603 x 700 can The can shall be made from 0.25 pound electrolytic tinplate per base box Alternatively, a 0 20 pound tinplate per base box or ECCS plate is acceptable provided the entire inside area of the can is enameled

D. Export packing. Six cans shall be packed in a fiberboard box constructed, closed, and reinforced in accordance with Grade V3c, V3s, or V4s, Style RSC of PPP-B-636 Reinforcement shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive, filament-reinforced tape

E. Unit loads (commercial and export). Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078. When unit loads are strapped, strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for Type II, Class F loads.

F. Labeling (commercial and export). Commercial labeling shall be acceptable

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

G. Marking (commercial and export). Marking of shipping containers and unit loads shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

Notes.

Purchasers should specify the Type

Sources of documents.

Sources of information for nongovernmental documents are as follows:

Copies of the National Motor Freight Classification may be obtained from.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent
National Motor Freight Classification
American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department
2200 Mill Road
Alexandria, VA 22314

Copies of the Uniform Freight Classification may be obtained from:

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent
Uniform Freight Classification
Uniform Classification Committee, Suite 1120
222 South Riverside Plaza
Chicago, IL 60606

Copies of the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC may be obtained from:

AOAC International
2200 Wilson Boulevard
Suite 400
Arlington, VA 22201-3301

Copies of the Food Chemicals Codex may be purchased from.

National Academy Press
2101 Constitution Avenue, NW
Washington, DC 20418

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Copies of the American Association of Cereal Chemists may be obtained from

American Association of Cereal Chemists
3340 Pilot Knob Road
St. Paul, MN 55121

Copies of the Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products may be obtained from

American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association
One Maritime Plaza
23rd Floor
San Francisco, CA 94111

Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1-199. This three-volume set may be purchased from

Superintendent of Documents
U.S. Government Printing Office
Washington, DC 20402-0001

Credit card (MasterCard or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 783-3238

Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from

Chairperson
Condition of Container Committee
Agricultural Marketing Service
U.S. Department of Agriculture
Room 2506, South Building
P.O. Box 96456
Washington, DC 20090-6456

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Information concerning licensed suppliers of USDA color standards for frozen french-fried potatoes may be obtained from

Chief
Processed Products Branch
Fruit and Vegetable Division
Agricultural Marketing Service
U.S. Department of Agriculture
Room 0709, South Building
P.O. Box 96456
Washington, DC 20090-6456

Civil agencies may obtain copies of this CID from

General Services Administration
Specifications Unit (3FB-WS)
Room 6654
7th and D Streets, SW
Washington, DC 20407

Military activities should submit requests for copies of this CID to:

Standardization Documents Order Desk
Building 4, Section D
700 Robbins Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review Activities

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DP - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - FDA, NIH, IHS
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

Army - GL

Project No 8915-0864

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T08:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.